

Interview Mindset

To make a copy of this document click [here](#), then go to File → Make a Copy.

Golden Idea

You need to come into the interview process with the proper mindset & beliefs to be successful — here is the framing you need to nail those interviews & land that dream offer.

Table Of Contents

 [The Power Law of Interviewing](#)

 [Luck of the Draw](#)

 [Over-Preparation](#)

 [Systematic Deconstruction](#)

 [Avoid Over-Congratulations](#)

 [Don't Cheat](#)



The Power Law of Interviewing

In the world of interviewing and job applications, all you need is 1 job offer — 1 time where everything goes right for it to be all worth it. You send out 100s of applications, conduct dozens of online assessments, many coding and behavioral interviews, and finally, you land 1 offer.

Now, this concept is called a “Power Law” — it’s a mathematical concept, but in simple terms, **a power law suggests that a few large events (or successes) account for most of the effects or results**, while the majority of events are relatively small or insignificant.

And that’s exactly what job interviews are like — again, you try for tons of opportunities, you land 1 offer, and it makes all of that effort worth it. The 1 success pays for the 99 failures.

What does this mean? Well, just because you try 100 times and you only succeed 1 time — that doesn’t make the 99 failures “not worth it.”

- The problem is **you don’t know which company is going to be the success** — so you have to go through all 100 to find out.
- See, if you could see the future and someone told you which opportunity was going to be the one that pays off and gets you the offer, you’d only do that one — except you can’t, **so you have to do all of them.**

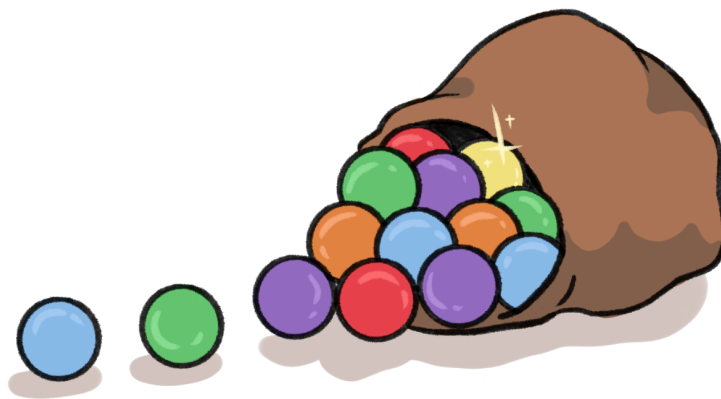
Just to summarize — you need to keep on grinding your ass off on these interviews until you get your offer — and when you get your offer, it pays for everything. **The only way you lose is if you quit.**



Luck of the Draw

Think of interviewing as drawing marbles from a bag — each marble is a company you're interviewing for, and you're searching for a golden marble — the company that's going to give you that job offer.

Now, this bag is opaque — you can't actually see into it. Also, new marbles appear in it every week.



Every time you interview for a company it's like drawing a marble - and the more qualified / better at interviewing you are, the more golden marbles there are & the more marbles are in the bag (because you get more interviews).

Problems:

- Empty Bag (No Interviews)
- No Golden Marbles (Can't Pass Interviews)
- Quitting Before Drawing A Golden Marble (Quitting Early)

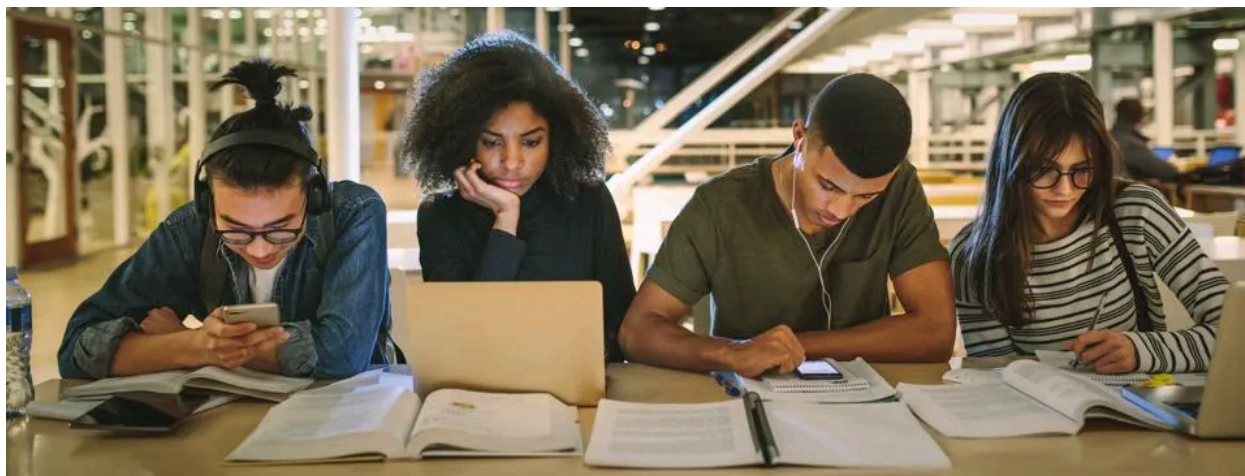
We need to concurrently work on all three — which is the point of this program.

What are the lessons we learn from this analogy?

- First of all, you never know which draw is going to get you that golden marble. You can't walk into an interview truly knowing if you will or won't definitively get that offer — and if you knew for sure, then you'd only do the interviews that you get an offer for, right?
 - That's why you need to do pretty much every interview & not stop taking OAs and interviews until you get your offer. The only surefire way to never get a golden marble is to stop drawing.
 - **Never avoid an interview or an OA** — at a minimum, open it up and try it for 20-30 mins. Not taking is the same as rejection — there's no downside to trying.
 - Do all OAs and interviews as a general rule.
 - Exception: Sometimes don't do the Quant OAs if you aren't going for Quant (Optiver 3h OA).
- Second, if you draw a not golden marble, don't stare at it and wonder all week long why it isn't golden. You've already drawn it. It makes no difference — the most important marble is the NEXT one.

The most important interview is the next one.

- Forget about the not-golden marble for 1-2 weeks and keep drawing more and more — if you fail an interview or already take one, it makes no difference — why are you pondering it all day long.
- You have no control over it. Put all that effort into the next draw. Trust me on this. This is a numbers game — I know how this goes, people always hyperfixate on how 1 interview went, calling their friends and family, posting on Reddit, Googling the result (and I do this to), when it doesn't matter at all.
 - Third, it doesn't matter how many marbles are golden if you have an empty bag, which is why we started with the previous course — Get The Interview, so you can fill your bag, and now we teach you how to make more marbles golden through preparation.
 - Fourth, if you have a full bag and you keep drawing, the only thing we need to do is work our ass off to make sure as many marbles are golden as possible. In other words, we need to ensure that you are AS PREPARED AS POSSIBLE.



Over-Preparation

In this game, no one has more than 100 marbles in their bag — most people, even with this program, really only get 10-20 opportunities max to interview and get that offer.

Which is why we need to prepare like f*cking hell to get that job — we need a philosophy of over-preparation. Remember this now, there is NO amount of preparation that is enough for an interview. You are never done. Never tell yourself that “I’ve done enough” or “there’s not much I can do” because that’s not true.

- See, I’ve done a ton of interviews — but because I had a philosophy of overpreparation, I probably got offers from 20-30% of the companies I interviewed for. Because I would always prepare like a demon.
- Now, when the actual interview arrives, sure there’s nothing you can do at that point. But really really work at preparing before then to do your absolute damn best, because you get a limited # of opportunities in this game, so take your best shot.

You never walk into an interview without 10-20h of preparation — never. Trust me on this. You will thank yourself for the work you put in.



Systematic Deconstruction

Our approach is simple — *work on every aspect of the interview process, starting with your weakest links, but still address everything.*

- Behavioral Interview
- LeetCode
- Coding Interview
- Values & Mission

We start with the weakest area, but we do not walk away without improving everything. This is a common mistake I see — people often convince themselves “I’m good” and avoid working on some categories, like behavioral or coding. **But you need to prep EVERYTHING.**

Don’t avoid certain areas because you think you’re ready.



🎉 Avoid Over-Congratulations

You shouldn't congratulate yourself just because you get an interview — while I do want to see you post that in Wins because it is a Win, **don't think to yourself that it's a massive celebration that you need to tell everyone.**

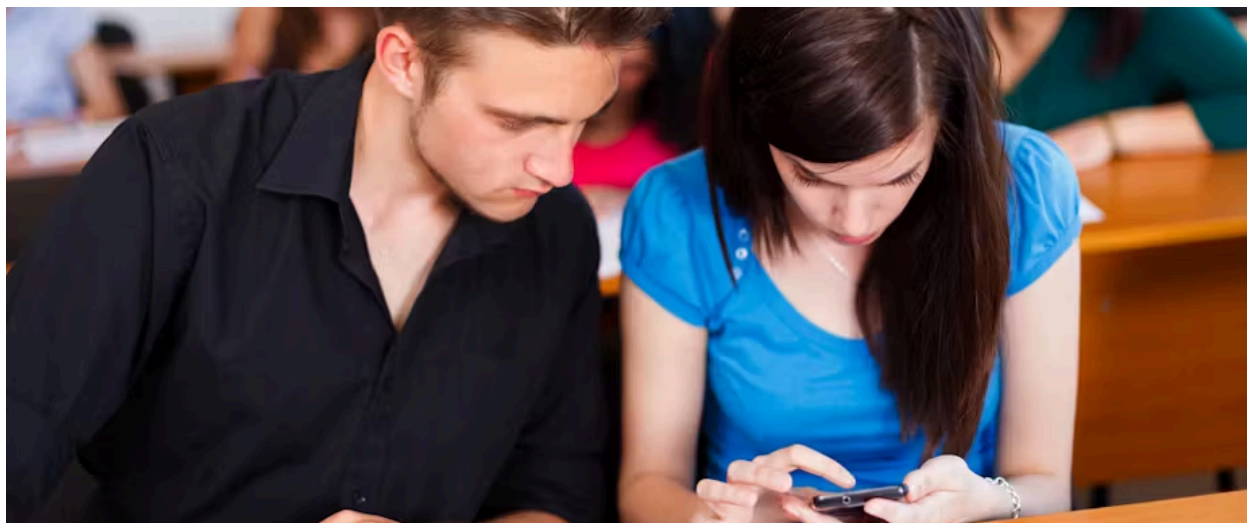
The dopamine system is fickle — getting an interview, especially a final round interview, especially from a name brand company feels AMAZING. But you're tricking your brain into thinking that you've done something, and while it's an achievement, **you're not done yet.**

You need to preserve that motivation to actually do your 10-20h of preparation.

- I got the Amazon Final Round a few years back, and I genuinely remember screaming with joy with the Avengers Soundtrack playing in my head — and while that was a win & I did get the offer in the end, **that mindset definitely did not help me.** I didn't have as much motivation and discipline to study & prepare as I should have.

Don't tell tons and tons of people — don't talk about how excited you are to interview.

Instead, please share it in the Wins channel because it's motivation for others & it helps me help you prepare.



✗ Don't Cheat

I define cheating in the context of an interview as using resources not allowed such as ChatGPT, Google (if not allowed), or another person.

Cheating is very common in this process — I know multiple people who have done it. Some have passed OAs because of it, and some have gotten caught and **blacklisted from a company forever**.

- I understand the temptation — this is one of the most important things in your life, so you convince yourself that you need the offer by any means necessary.

Here's why you shouldn't cheat, even though you do get a short-term gain:

1. **Undermines Integrity:** Cheating compromises your personal and professional integrity. Companies value honesty and trust, and getting caught in dishonesty could damage your reputation, making it difficult to secure jobs in the future.
2. **Lack of Skill Development:** The purpose of OAs and interviews is to assess your abilities and identify areas where you can improve. Cheating prevents you from recognizing your weaknesses, stunting your growth as a professional.
3. **Job Mismatch:** If you cheat, you may secure a job that doesn't match your actual skills. This can lead to frustration and failure when you are unable to meet the job's expectations, possibly resulting in job loss or burnout.

4. **Long-Term Consequences:** Many industries are small, and your reputation follows you. Being dishonest can lead to a poor reputation within the industry, limiting future opportunities and connections.
5. **Legal and Ethical Violations:** Some companies have legal agreements for candidates to uphold honesty during assessments. Violating these agreements could lead to legal consequences of being blacklisted from future opportunities.

Become so good they can't ignore you. Become so good at LeetCode, coding, & behavioral interviews that they have no choice but to give you the offer. That's a much better and more robust strategy to success.

- You need to trust that you will be successful in the long run, even without cheating. Have faith that taking the high road & having integrity will win in the long term.
 - This is not a moral self-righteous thing — I just want to make it clear because it's so common.
- The expected value of cheating is not actually positive — it does more harm than good in the long run, even if some people get away with it. Sometimes, it's okay to fail an interview.